

JUNE 2019

Anniversary month and the start of the monsoon, and even in the tech world, when it rains it pours...



ANOTHER GOOGLE CLOUD OUTAGE

Everything from Play Store, YouTube, and all G Suite

services went down at this time. Not only were Google services down, but also others that depend on their servers, such as Snapchat, Discord, and others. What's worse, no one knew what happened, and Google were tight lipped about why their services were down.

MY NAME IS ALEXA

No it isn't baby, no it isn't! It was reported in June that a baby was responding to the name Alexa, even though the baby's name is Caroline. A video posted online reveals how often the baby hears the word, and obviously likes the consequences because the mother was using Alexa to play nursery rhymes or something the baby liked.

CANCER!

No we're not talking about the disease, we're talking about the YouTube comments

section which is often called cancer, and with good reason. It seems all you find there are trolls and the scourge of humanity, eager to outdo themselves to reach the goal of most disgusting thing a human can say. It makes Twitter look like a kindergarten class. So we all rejoiced when YouTube started testing the hiding of the comments section by default. Sure, you could still get to it if you wanted to... but who wants to?



THAT'S PHOTOSHOPPED!

We have all used that phrase at some point or the other, because of how common it is to see edited images. In June it was announced that a research team had taught an AI to be able to recognise when Photoshop was used to edit a person's face. The AI specifically looked for edits made using Photoshop's Face Aware Liquify feature. Of course, it will be a while (if ever) before we can develop an AI that

can just look at a picture and tell you what edits have been made to it, but if that were the case, deep fakes and the like will find it harder to fool humans.

BYE JONY IVE

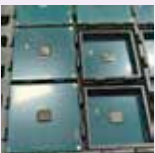
The end of an era, some called it, because that's how integrated the idea of Apple's design was with Jony Ive. Those with insider knowledge had seen it coming for years after Steve Jobs' death, as Ive went from the guy whose own designs defined Apple to somewhat of a manager of the department.

Also

- A 15-year-old stabbed his brother to death for not letting him play PUBG
- Indian engineering student gets WWDC 2019 scholarship from Apple
- Samsung announce that Galaxy Fold's issues have been solved
- President Trump reinstated business with Huawei after a G20 summit
- Apple iTunes to be shut down for good.

JULY 2019

Proper monsoon season, and Mumbai folk start drowning right on schedule, allowing those of us who work in Mumbai to work from home. Hot pakodas and chai! Ahhh, this is the life!



SHAKTI SDK

IIT Madras researchers released an SDK for our first indigenously designed microproces-

sor. The processor is open source, and is based on the RISC-V instruction set. The processor wasn't out then, but releasing the SDK allowed people to begin developing software for it, so that the software and hardware could come to market at the same time.

for a bit, so where will people complain then? Maybe LinkedIn? Or Reddit? Who knows...



CHANDRAYAAN-2

After being delayed from its original July 15 launch date, and then again from its second launch date on July 18, Chandrayaan-2, the country's mission to the moon, was finally launched successfully on July 22.



JIO

July also saw Reliance Jio become the largest telecom operator in the country, just three years after launching! Jio's subscriber base was 331.3 million people at the end of July, and previous topper Vodafone dropped from 334.1 million to 320 million. And now they're increasing mobile tariff rates along with other telecom service providers, just when we got used to ridiculously cheap network plans :-(



FACEBOOK OUTAGE

WhatsApp, Facebook and Instagram faced outages all across the globe,

in yet another example of how cloud apps can still fail. This happened on July 3 for a few hours, and Twitter lit up with people complaining left and right. Pretty soon it also will be Twitter's turn to go down



\$5 BILLION FINE

Facebook was given a \$5 Billion fine by the Federal Trade Commission (FTC) on July 24, thanks to its involvement with the Cambridge Analytica scandal, and their lack of action leading up to it. Because 50 million users had their data harvested, this worked out to about \$100 per user in fines.

Also

- India slipped 3 positions in both mobile and fixed broadband country rankings by Ookla. Since then it has slipped even further...
- Scientists create artificial sun in a lab
- Apple has a successful quarter, selling \$26 million worth of phones in AMJ
- Agent Smith malware affects 15 million mobile phones in India